

# SAGA TWO BIBLE: THE SECRET WARS SAGA

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Phases 4–6 (2021–2031) · Big Bad: DOCTOR DOOM

Status:  LOCKED (the overall structure). The slates and dossiers come when each phase opens.

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## 1. THE FORMAT

| Phase   | Years     | Movies    | Disney+ series |
|---------|-----------|-----------|----------------|
| Phase 4 | 2021–2024 | 9         | 2              |
| Phase 5 | 2025–2027 | 10        | 2              |
| Phase 6 | 2028–2031 | 11        | 2              |
| Total   | 2021–2031 | 30 movies | 6 series       |

Rules (locked):

1. **The movies are the main story.** Every essential beat of the saga happens **on the big screen**.
  2. **Disney+ series are limited to two per phase**, not two per year.
  3. The series **go deeper and wider** (street-level heroes, supporting characters, side stories), but **you never have to watch a series to follow the movies**. Series events can be *referenced* in films, and are always explained there.
  4. Every series gets a **Series Dossier** (same template as the films, plus episode count, runtime and release pattern), written automatically.
  5. All earlier rules still apply: **Earth-616, comic accuracy, nobody gets nerfed, the Casting Rules, real-time continuity and automatic dossiers**.
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## 2. THE BIG BAD: VICTOR VON DOOM

**First appearance:** *Fantastic Four* #5 (July 1962), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby.

**Played by:** **Robert Downey Jr.** (locked in *Fantastic Four*, 2013). In our reality Doom is his signature Marvel role.

## Why Doom

1. **He's Marvel's greatest villain.** He's a genius equal to Reed Richards, a **master sorcerer**, **the absolute monarch of Latveria**, and a man who has **stolen the Power Cosmic** and **taken godhood**. No other 616 villain has done as much.
2. **He's already on the board.** We met him in *Fantastic Four* (2013), when he beat all four of them in round one and **escaped by sorcery**. His mid-credit scene set up his **time platform**. In *Avengers Forever* (2019) he **went for the Infinity Gauntlet himself**. Doom has been watching the heroes lose since 2013.
3. **He's the opposite of Thanos.** Thanos was a nihilist who wanted to be loved by Death. **Doom is a man who believes he should rule everything, and he might be right**. He wants to **save the universe**, and to be the one who owns it.
4. **The 616 story is already written.** Jonathan Hickman's run (*Avengers / New Avengers*, 2012–15) leads to *Secret Wars* (2015–16), where **the multiverse dies** and **Doom rebuilds what's left as its God**. It's the definitive modern 616 epic, and it grows out of **the Illuminati**, whom we already set up in *Planet Hulk* (2018).
5. **Nobody is nerfed, and that includes the villain.** At the saga's height, **Doom takes the power of the Beyonders** and becomes **God Emperor Doom**. The heroes have to beat something **even bigger than the Infinity Gauntlet**.

## Comic-accurate canon (locked)

- **Origin:** a Romani boy from **Latveria**. His mother **Cynthia** made a pact with **Mephisto** and died for it. **Mephisto already exists in our MCU** (Ciarán Hinds), and **Doom's lifelong goal is to free his mother's soul from Mephisto**.
- **At Empire State University** his forbidden machine exploded after **Reed warned him**. He trained with **Tibetan monks**, put on **the mask while it was still red-hot**, and took **Latveria**.
- **Science and sorcery:** Doom is both. He's **Sorcerer Supreme-class** (on 616 he took the title in 2015), and his technology rivals Reed's.
- **His code:** Doom **keeps his word**, protects **Latveria's people**, and **never lets anyone else kill Reed Richards**.
- **Doom isn't evil in his own eyes.** He's **the only one competent enough to save everything**.

## The cosmic threat behind him: the Beyonders and the Incursions

- **Incursions:** two universes' Earths **collide**, and **both universes die** unless one of the two Earths is destroyed first (Hickman's *New Avengers*, 2013).
- **The Beyonders**, beings from beyond the multiverse, are **deliberately destroying it** (*Avengers/New Avengers*, 2015).
- **The Molecule Man** (Owen Reece) is **the bomb they planted in every universe**, and **Doom's key to beating them** (*Secret Wars*, 2015).
- **The Illuminati have to decide which worlds die**, and that drives them apart. **Black Panther** vs. **Namor**. **Cap** vs. **Tony**.

- **In memory of Chadwick Boseman (1976–2020):** under the real-history rule, **T'Challa died in the MCU in 2020, off-screen, of illness. Shuri (Letitia Wright) is Black Panther** (616: *Black Panther* vol. 5, 2009) and takes **Wakanda's seat among the Illuminati**. The role Hickman wrote for T'Challa is hers.

### 3. THE SAGA NAME: THE SECRET WARS SAGA

#### Why this name:

- It's taken straight from 616: ***Secret Wars*** (1984–85, Jim Shooter, **the Beyonder, Battleworld, Doom steals the Beyonder's power**) and ***Secret Wars*** (2015–16, Jonathan Hickman, **the multiverse ends, God Emperor Doom**). **Both Secret Wars climax with Doom becoming a god.**
- Like "the Infinity Saga," it's **the name of a story, not a franchise**. The public won't hear it until the right moment.
- It fits the secrecy that runs through the whole plan: **the Illuminati's secret war** to save reality, fought behind the backs of the heroes who trust them.

#### The three-phase arc (following Hickman's structure)

| Phase                       | Hickman arc                                                            | Where the saga is                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Phase 4</b><br>(2021–24) | <b>"Everything Dies"</b><br>( <i>Avengers/New Avengers</i><br>2012–14) | <b>The first Incursion.</b> The <b>Illuminati</b> re-form in secret. <b>The multiverse is revealed.</b> Doom <b>watches, and prepares.</b>                                                                 |
| <b>Phase 5</b><br>(2025–27) | <b>"Time Runs Out"</b> (2015)                                          | <b>The Illuminati and the Avengers go to war over which worlds die.</b> Doom <b>hunts the Beyonders.</b> The universes run out.                                                                            |
| <b>Phase 6</b><br>(2028–31) | <b>"Secret Wars"</b> (2015–16)<br>and <b><i>Secret Wars</i></b> (1984) | <b>The multiverse ends. Battleworld. God Emperor Doom.</b> The heroes' final war against a god who <b>did</b> save everything. The ending: <b>Reed rebuilds the multiverse, and Doom's face is healed.</b> |

#### Seeding plan

- **Phase 4:** a **second Earth appears in the sky** over Wakanda (the first Incursion, *New Avengers* #1, 2013). T'Challa calls the Illuminati. **The Black Swan.** Doom's **time platform** comes back. Mephisto and Doom **start their war over his mother's soul.**
- **Phase 5:** "Time Runs Out." The **Cabal** (Namor's Earth-destroyers) splits from the heroes. **Doom meets the Beyonders. The last Incursion begins.**
- **Final shot of Phase 5:** everything goes **white**, then a single title card: **"SECRET WARS."**
- **Phase 6:** Battleworld. God Emperor Doom. The saga's two-part finale.

## 4. HOW THE INFINITY SAGA CARRIES OVER

| Carries over                                                               | How it matters                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Illuminati</b> ( <i>Planet Hulk</i> )                               | Hickman's <b>core cast</b>                                                  |
| <b>The heroes who remember five lost years</b> ( <i>Avengers Forever</i> ) | They know <b>reality can be rewritten</b> , and <b>Doom knows they know</b> |
| <b>Doom going for the Gauntlet</b> ( <i>Avengers Forever</i> )             | He <b>tasted godhood</b> , and he wants it back                             |
| <b>Mephisto</b> (Ciarán Hinds)                                             | <b>The keeper of Doom's mother's soul</b>                                   |
| <b>Warlock and the Infinity Watch</b>                                      | <b>The Gems are scattered.</b> Doom knows where they are.                   |
| <b>Harry Osborn and the Goblin mask</b> ( <i>Spider-Man 2</i> )            | Street-level thread, a candidate for Disney+                                |